

“Let me say what I want to say first. It doesn’t matter about the problems anymore. We’ll work them out together as long as you’ll let me help. I have decided to close my checking account and put the money into our joint account. I have about five hundred dollars in savings, and I want us to use it to pay off some of the debts.”

“Honey, I can’t do that,” Ben protested. “You earned that money. It seems like somebody else always has to clean up my messes.”

“No, you’re wrong. The money is not mine,” Naomi said emphatically. “It’s not really even ours. It belongs to God. We seem to have forgotten that somewhere along the way. I want the money in my account to be used for our expenses.”

They just stood there several seconds holding each other. Then Naomi said, “Ben, a letter came from the IRS today. I didn’t want to open it, so I left it on the table.”

“Oh, no, what now?” Ben said as he picked up the envelope from the table. “I know we don’t owe any money to the IRS—at least I don’t think we do.”

Opening the envelope Ben let out a whoop. “Naomi, we don’t owe any money! This is a check for nearly nine hundred dollars!”

“Why did they send us a check?” Naomi asked as she began to relax her body from the shock she had expected.

“Let’s see, the letter says that we overpaid our taxes because of an error in computation. Well, praise the Lord! At least my math errors worked in our favor this time. With this we’ll be able to pay off some debts and still have some of the money in your account left. Let’s go out and celebrate tonight.”

“No way,” Naomi responded. “That’s the kind of thinking that got us into this fix in the first place.”

“Just kidding,” Ben said with a big grin. “I would much rather stay home and celebrate with my family.”

Two weeks later, Ben and Naomi were back in Bryan Stanford’s office. “Well, I’m really glad to see you two again,” he began. “Obviously your presence here means you have decided to work